

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

The first thing that you need to do is to try to connect that bad feeling you're having to a particular event or decision. Sometime the threads connecting the actual act to the residual feeling can take a little while to trace – we don't always associate the fact that we feel anxious about money to that inheritance that we blew, or the fact that we're overspending on our children now to the fact that we couldn't afford to spoil them when they were younger etc. You can either work through all this in your head or journal it out, but it's hard to move forward in forgiving yourself if you can't actually pinpoint what you feel you did wrong.

The next step is to work out to what extent the mistake was your fault, using some of the insights you've gained from the early parts of this chapter. Consider why you made the choices that you made – were you an active participant, or were you passively allowing things to happen? Did you make those choices based on information that's different to the information available to you now? What were the external pressures involved?

Then, try to consider why you behaved that way. Can you access some of the thoughts and feelings that you were having at the time? Can you think about what mattered to you then, whether you were acting on a selfish impulse or trying to impress or please others?

Make sure that you're considering your mistakes from a place of compassion – try to suspend your judgement of yourself